

Impact High · Difficulty Hard · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

Name what you need -> Not what they did wrong -> Invite the alternative

START HERE

State your boundary as a need you have, not as a complaint about what they did. One sentence. Then stop.

SAY THIS

Boundary Statements	<i>"I am not able to take that on right now."</i>
Alternatives	<i>"What I can offer instead is..."</i>
Personal Boundaries	<i>"I love that you thought of me, and I need to sit this one out."</i>
Workload Boundaries	<i>"My plate is full — if this is the new priority, something needs to come off."</i>
Holding Under Press...	<i>"I have heard everything you said, and the answer is still no."</i>

AVOID

- When the behaviour is so serious that a firm objection — not a politely framed boundary — is the right response.
- In safety-critical situations requiring immediate compliance rather than a collaborative conversation.
- In significant power imbalances where a boundary will be ignored or punished — escalation through other channels may be needed.

REMEMBER

Say it as your need, not their fault.